

1 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Pack for the pretend trip

What we are practising

Prioritize needs within a simple limit.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Name the items aloud rather than drawing cards.

Before you begin

Imagine a two-hour shaded park visit with an adult and space for four item types.

This is pretend planning; an adult decides actual travel supplies and any individual health needs.

Try it together

1. List six possible items, such as water, hat, snack, notebook, toy and spare shirt.
2. Choose four and explain the reason for each.
3. Change the scenario to an indoor visit and reconsider the choices.
4. Agree which choices depend on weather or personal needs.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which item serves an essential need, and which is an optional extra?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A fair turn-taking plan

What we are practising

State a preference, listen and agree on a practical turn rule.

What you need

One shared drawing sheet / Two pencils

Use imaginary turns on a pretend swing.

Before you begin

Choose a shared drawing goal, such as a garden.

Keep it voluntary and stop if the game becomes upsetting; adults handle real disputes that need help.

Try it together

1. Each person says one thing they want to add.
2. Agree on turns, such as one feature per turn.
3. Take four turns each and notice whether the rule works.
4. If someone needs more help or time, agree on an adjustment together.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Is a fair agreement always exactly the same for everyone?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Morning routine puzzle

What we are practising

Plan a sequence that satisfies more than one condition.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Draw the five actions rather than writing them.

Before you begin

Use these actions: get dressed, eat breakfast, brush teeth, pack bag, leave.

These are fictional puzzle rules; follow your family's actual care routine.

Try it together

1. Write each action on a separate large paper card or in a list.
2. Apply the rules: breakfast before brushing teeth; packing before leaving; leaving last.
3. Choose one order that follows all rules.
4. Find a different valid order and explain what moved.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which parts are fixed by the rules, and which are flexible?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Ask a useful question

What we are practising

Notice ambiguity and ask a specific clarification question.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use spoken role-play only.

Before you begin

An adult prepares vague fictional requests such as put the book over there.

Use harmless pretend requests; children can decline requests that feel unsafe or uncomfortable.

Try it together

1. Listen to one vague request without acting on it.
2. Name the missing detail, such as which book or which place.
3. Ask a precise question, then repeat the clarified instruction.
4. Swap roles using another harmless request.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which question would help more: what? or which shelf?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 20 minutes

Make a shared-space checklist

What we are practising

Break a practical job into observable, manageable steps.

What you need

Paper / Pencils / A small drawing area

Use an imaginary desk drawn on paper.

Before you begin

Choose a small safe area and agree what ready to use means.

Adults handle cleaning chemicals, sharp items and heavy objects; this task uses only safe art materials.

Try it together

1. List three visible actions, such as cap pens, stack paper and return pencils.
2. Put the actions in a useful order and add checkboxes.
3. Test the checklist together after a short drawing session.
4. Change any instruction that was unclear or too large.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How will someone know each step is finished?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Two instructions that conflict

What we are practising

Recognise conflicting instructions and ask which requirement applies.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Identify a conflict and write a precise clarification request.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional poster task says “use only pencil” and later says “colour the title with a marker.” What should the group do before starting?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Leading one part, following another

What we are practising

Share leadership by matching different roles to different task stages.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Assign complementary leadership roles in a fictional project.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two characters organise a pretend gallery. One knows the pictures well; the other enjoys arranging space. How could they share leadership?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A plan with a fallback

What we are practising

Prepare an alternative that preserves a group activity's purpose.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Create a main plan and a backup for one fictional activity.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend drawing club plans to use an outdoor table. The story says it may rain. What backup keeps the same activity possible?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Breaking a tied vote

What we are practising

Agree on a process for resolving a tied group choice.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Propose two acceptable ways to resolve a fictional tied choice.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Four fictional club members vote: two choose a puppet story and two choose a drawing game. What fair next step could they agree?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

One shared tool, two tasks

What we are practising

Coordinate access to one tool around different task needs.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Choose an order for sharing a tool and explain the dependency.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two characters need one ruler. One must finish a border before a partner can add labels; the other can sketch while waiting. What order might help?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A change after everyone agreed

What we are practising

Reopen a shared decision when a proposed change affects others.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Write a brief conversation that reopens a changed group decision.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A group agrees on a blue poster background. One character changes it to red without telling anyone. How could the group repair the decision process?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Credit for a team picture

What we are practising

Acknowledge planning and checking alongside visible artwork.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Create a contribution card for a fictional group artwork.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

One character draws, another chooses the layout and a third checks labels. How could a display credit all contributions?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

An offer you can carry out

What we are practising

Match an offer of help to the time actually available.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Replace an oversized offer with a concrete smaller contribution.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional helper has ten minutes and offers to make twenty invitations, each expected to take about a minute. How could they offer something more realistic without abandoning the group?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Feedback that names the problem

What we are practising

Give specific feedback about an unclear instruction.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Turn a vague criticism into specific feedback about a rule.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend game rule says “move over there.” A tester says only “This is bad.” What feedback would help the writer improve it?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

What must happen before printing?

What we are practising

Order preparation and checking before making multiple copies.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Arrange writing, checking and copying in a reasoned order.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend flyer must be written, checked and then copied. Why could copying before checking create extra work?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A meeting with two decisions

What we are practising

Use a short agenda to keep two decisions distinct.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Write a two-point agenda for a fictional group meeting.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional club has five minutes to choose a story and a reader. How could a short agenda keep the talk focused?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Trading roles with consent

What we are practising

Negotiate a role exchange while leaving space to decline.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Write a respectful request to change a fictional team role.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A character agreed to present a poster but now prefers arranging pictures. How could it propose a swap without assuming another person will present?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

What does finished mean?

What we are practising

Agree on observable signs that a shared task is complete.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Define a clear finish for a fictional shared poster.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

One character thinks a poster is finished when the drawing is done; another expects a title too. What agreement could prevent the mismatch?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

An invitation with enough detail

What we are practising

Include the details a recipient needs to understand an invitation.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Improve an incomplete fictional invitation with necessary details.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional invitation says only “Join our game later.” What missing details would an invited person need?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Keep a record of shared choices

What we are practising

Record current group decisions so teammates can refer to the same plan.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Create a visible current-plan record for a fictional team.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A team changes its plan twice and now remembers different versions. How could one simple record help?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Pack for the pretend trip

A little hint

Think about thirst, weather and the planned activity before entertainment.

Answer / what to notice

Several lists can work; water is a strong priority for the park, and choices should have reasons suited to the scenario.

A useful packing list responds to the situation rather than including everything available.

Make it easier

Choose two items from four picture options.

Take it further

Assign each item a size of 1 or 2 and fit a total capacity of 6.

Another day, away from the screen

Help an adult check a real outing list without sharing it online.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. A fair turn-taking plan

A little hint

A useful rule is clear and can adapt to a person's needs.

Answer / what to notice

Any agreed rule can work if both can participate and ask for changes respectfully.

Fairness includes being heard and having a workable chance to take part.

Make it easier

An adult models one request and one response.

Take it further

Include a third person and agree how to handle an unfinished turn.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the agreed phrases in another low-stakes shared game.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Morning routine puzzle

A little hint

Nothing in these puzzle rules says when getting dressed must happen.

Answer / what to notice

One answer is dressed, breakfast, teeth, bag, leave. Another is breakfast, dressed, bag, teeth, leave.

The rules limit the order but do not determine a single solution.

Make it easier

Use just breakfast, teeth and leave.

Take it further

Add estimated durations and calculate a departure time.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a flexible checklist for a familiar non-urgent routine.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Ask a useful question

A little hint

Ask about one missing detail at a time.

Answer / what to notice

For put the book over there, useful questions include which book? and where exactly should it go?

Specific questions reduce uncertainty and let both people check the same meaning.

Make it easier

Choose a question from two adult-provided options.

Take it further

Clarify a task with two separate missing details.

Another day, away from the screen

Notice one everyday instruction that could be made clearer.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Make a shared-space checklist

A little hint

Replace tidy up with a specific action such as put all pencils in the box.

Answer / what to notice

A useful checklist has clear actions and a visible finish; different spaces need different lists.

Small specific steps make a shared task easier to understand and check.

Make it easier

Use two picture steps with adult help.

Take it further

Ask another person to follow the list without extra explanation and revise it.

Another day, away from the screen

Create a second checklist for putting away a board game.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. Two instructions that conflict

A little hint

Quote the two conflicting instructions in your question.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Ask which instruction applies to the title instead of silently choosing one. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Noticing contradictory requirements prevents avoidable rework.

Make it easier

Choose which two phrases cannot both be followed.

Take it further

Rewrite the instructions after inventing the organiser's clarification.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. Leading one part, following another

A little hint

Match a role to a stated interest, then include a joint check.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: One leads the captions, the other the layout, and both check the combined plan. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Leadership can be divided by task while keeping decisions connected.

Make it easier

Assign just one decision to each character.

Take it further

Swap roles halfway and explain what information must pass between them.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. A plan with a fallback

A little hint

Identify what depends on the weather and what does not.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: An agreed indoor table with the same paper materials could preserve the drawing plan. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A fallback changes the uncertain part while retaining the purpose.

Make it easier

Choose an imagined indoor table or indoor drawing corner.

Take it further

Specify when the group will decide which plan to use.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. Breaking a tied vote

A little hint

Choose a process before declaring a winner.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: They could discuss a combined activity, or agree now to alternate the two choices over two meetings. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A tie needs an agreed process; repeating the same vote may leave the same result.

Make it easier

Use a combined activity offered by an adult.

Take it further

Explain how your process treats someone who dislikes the combined option.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. One shared tool, two tasks

A little hint

Which task is currently holding up someone else?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: The border-maker could use the ruler first while the other sketches, with a clear handover afterward. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Considering task dependencies can reduce waiting for more than one person.

Make it easier

Draw arrows showing which task must wait.

Take it further

Revise the order if the border task takes longer than expected.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. A change after everyone agreed

A little hint

Discuss the process as well as the colour.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Pause, explain the change, and ask whether the group wants to keep it or return to the agreed version. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Repairing a shared decision includes acknowledging the change and restoring participation.

Make it easier

Start with “I changed something we agreed on.”

Take it further

Agree on a rule for future changes that affect everyone.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. Credit for a team picture

A little hint

Name actions rather than only the person who held the pencil.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A fictional contribution card could list drawing, layout and checking as three useful roles. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Less visible planning and checking can contribute to a shared result too.

Make it easier

List two different contributions.

Take it further

Ask whether anyone's contribution is missing before finalising it.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. An offer you can carry out

A little hint

Choose a useful part you can describe clearly.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: It could offer to draft one invitation template and explain what others still need to do. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A specific manageable contribution is easier to plan around than an uncertain large promise.

Make it easier

Choose one small offer: make a sample invitation or check two completed invitations.

Take it further

Add a check-in point if the helper finishes early.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. Feedback that names the problem

A little hint

Quote the unclear phrase.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: “I do not know which space ‘there’ means. Could you name or mark it?” Other reasoned ideas can work.

Useful feedback identifies an observable problem and a possible clarification.

Make it easier

Complete “I was unsure about...”

Take it further

Separate a personal preference from something the rule must explain.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. What must happen before printing?

A little hint

Compare correcting one page with correcting many.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: An error found later would need fixing in every copy instead of just the original. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Some checks are more efficient before work is duplicated.

Make it easier

Draw three labelled boxes for writing, checking and copying, then put checking in the middle.

Take it further

Decide what should be checked again after copying.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. A meeting with two decisions

A little hint

State what must be decided, not every possible discussion topic.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: List the two decisions, choose the story first, then ask for a willing reader. Other reasoned ideas can work.

An agenda makes the intended decisions visible and gives the conversation an order.

Make it easier

Choose which decision should come first.

Take it further

Add a way to record a question that must wait until later.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. Trading roles with consent

A little hint

Distinguish an invitation to swap from an instruction.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Ask whether someone is willing to swap, explain the preference, and keep discussing if nobody agrees. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A proposed role change becomes an agreement only when the affected people accept it.

Make it easier

Complete “Would anyone like to swap...?”

Take it further

Find a third arrangement if no direct swap works.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. What does finished mean?

A little hint

Name observable features that can be checked.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Agree in advance that finished means a drawing, a readable title and a final check together. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Shared completion criteria make different expectations visible.

Make it easier

Choose two things the finished poster must contain.

Take it further

Distinguish essential features from optional decoration.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. An invitation with enough detail

A little hint

Ask what, when and where; use invented details.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: They need the game, a clear time and an agreed pretend location. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A useful invitation gives enough information to decide and take part.

Make it easier

Add only the game and time first.

Take it further

Include whether any materials are needed without adding private information.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. Keep a record of shared choices

A little hint

Show which version everyone agreed to use.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A page marked “current plan” can list the agreed version and cross out superseded choices. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Distinguishing the current decision from old ideas reduces confusion.

Make it easier

Mark one of two plans as the current choice.

Take it further

Add the reason for one change so it is easier to understand later.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.